

# CHAPTER NINE: NIGHTMARES & STRANGER THINGS

*I am the "who" when you call "Who's there?"  
I am the wind blowing through your hair.  
I am the shadow on the moon at night,  
Filling your dreams to the brim with fright  
—The Nightmare Before Christmas*

Changelings walk in two worlds, but they are alone in neither realm. Threats and dangers abound no matter where they go. Feral chimera and nightmare horrors lurk in the Near Dreaming. Dark fae and ancient enemies invade from the Deep Dreaming and Nightmare Realms. The World of Darkness is no safer: it teems with Glamour-destroying mortals, bloodthirsty vampires, feral werewolves, reality-bending mages, and even stranger Prodigal cousins. Not every non-Kithain denizen is an active threat, but some mortals and Prodigals are so steeped in Banality that they can damage a changeling simply by their very presence.

This chapter provides a variety of templates for chimera, mortal, fae, and supernatural allies, contacts and threats to flesh out your chronicle's supporting cast.

## Prodigals

Some fae races forget their true natures. These lost races are collectively known as Prodigals. Whether or not they're truly fae, changelings exist who wish to bring these creatures back into the fold, where others would see them avoided, or destroyed.

The descent of Banality across the world following the Shattering disturbed the relationships Kithain possessed with these creatures, as survival became paramount over games of politics. Dealings grew cold as magi began to exploit the Dreaming, sects of vampires desired experimentation with changeling blood, and werewolves — temperamental partners at the best of times — lashed out against their unreliable fae allies in retribution for wrongs, real and imagined.

The changelings are hardly blameless for the withering of friendships given their variable attitudes. Tentative fingers have long reached out for the hands